A-A-51237A
18 September 1989
SUPERSEDES
A-A-51237
20 November 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BACTERIOLOGICAL SPECIMEN COLLECTION AND TRANSPORTATION SYSTEM (Anaerobic Bacteria, Collecting and Transporting)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a sterile collection and transport system.

Salient characteristics.

Shall be a sterile collection/transport system suitable for collecting and holding anaerobic biologic cultures (e.g. Bacteroide sp., Clostridium sp., Eubacterium sp.) moist and viable for 48 hours in an anaerobic environment.

As a minimum, shall include the following:

1. A transparent or translucent semi-rigid collection tube containing a pledget, a crushable ampule containing reduced Cary-Blair transport media, a hydrogen gas generating tablet, a crushable ampule containing activation solution for the hydrogen gas generating tablet.

2. A plastic closure cap with an attached applicator stick that terminates with a polyester tipped swab.

3. A plastic sleeve (envelope) for holding the collection tube and closure cap. The plastic material shall be sterilizable, and impermeable to hydrogen gas. The sleeve shall have an open end to facilitate ready access to an inserted collection tube and closure cap.

AMSC N/A FSC 6550

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4. A metal closure key for closing the open end of the plastic sleeve. The metal closure key construction shall include a slot and bendable tabs. Closure of the sleeve shall be accomplished by inserting the open end into the slot and folding over the frame of the key (in accordance with manufacturer's instructions), and then manually bending the tabs to hold the folded section of sleeve in place.

5. A peel-open type outer wrap to hold - until ready for use - the collection tube, closure cap with applicator stick, plastic sleeve and metal closure key. The outerwrap shall not be resealable after opening.

6. Printed instructions.

Within the sealed peel-open type outer wrap, all surfaces of the anaerobic collection/transport culture system (including inside surfaces of the outerwrap) shall be supplied in a sterile condition. The sealed peel-open type outer wrap shall maintain the sterility of its contents until it is manually opened.

The distal end of the collection tube shall be closed to preclude leakage of the transport media. The opposite end shall be open and shall accommodate the closure cap for a snug-fitting and readily removable type closure.

A suitable adhesive or friction fit shall be used to secure the applicator stick to the inside of the closure cap. A suitable adhesive shall be used to secure the swab tip to the distal end of the applicator stick.

The volume of transport media shall be sufficient to moisten all surfaces of the swab tip, after the media has saturated the pledget, and keep any collected live cultures located on any sector (surface) of the swab tip viable for 48 hours.

In the collection tube, the ampule of transport media shall be located below the pledget so as to separate it from the applicator swab on the closure cap when it is seated fully in place in the tube.

The hydrogen gas tablet and ampule with activating solution shall be located at the bottom portion of the collection tube.

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Suitable means shall be included within the collection tube for holding the pledget and capsules in place without any tendency to shift.

The manufacturer's printed instructions shall include the method of moistening the swab tip and producing and maintaining an anaerobic (hydrogen) environment.

When the swab tip is moistened, by following manufacturer's instructions, the released transport media shall completely moisten the swab tip without exhibiting the following:

1. A coating or splattering of the transport media on the upper portion of the applicator stick (i.e., upper half of the exposed length).

2. A coating or splattering of the transport media on the upper half of the inside surfaces of the collection tube.

3. A coating or splattering of the transport media on the outside of the collection tube.

4. The intertwining of fibers of pledget and swab tip causing the pledget to be drawn up the inside of the collection tube as applicator stick cap is removed from closure position.

When the plastic sleeve, containing the collection cap seated (in accordance with manufacturer's instructions), is closed with the metal closure key and hydrogen gas released (in accordance with manufacturer's instructions), the proper anaerobic environment within the plastic sleeve shall be indicated by the sleeve becoming inflated without evidence of hydrogen leakage from the sleeve.

Workmanship. The anaerobic collection/transport system shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing fifty individually packaged sterile biological culture tubes, as specified, constitutes one unit.

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practiceto determine compliance with specification requirements. The sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request snould be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/ contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6550-01-293-1899

Ordering data. (Expiration dating period required intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6550-0089

Location: cid/bacteriological/S31/17

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51237A	Bacteriological Specimen Collection and Transportation System

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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